

August 20, 2026

Humana
Provider Correspondence
P.O. Box 14601
Lexington, KY 40512

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Jed Pollich (MRN MUSC6746441), Claim MUSC-72D8-1

Patient	Jed Pollich (DOB 1968-03-01)
MRN	MUSC6746441
Member ID / Group	HUM343732532 / GRP-55180
Claim number	MUSC-72D8-1
Date of service	2026-05-21
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$600.13
Denial code	CARC 96 / RARC N130 — Non-covered charge(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-09-10

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this first-level appeal on behalf of patient Jed Pollich (MRN: MUSC6746441, Member ID: HUM343732532) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-72D8-1 for a date of service of May 21, 2026. Humana denied the claim in full, citing CARC 96 ("Non-covered charge(s)") and RARC N130 ("Consult plan benefit documents/guidelines for information about restrictions for this service"), with the payer remark stating "Service is excluded under the member's plan benefit document." The total denied amount is \$600.13 for one unit of CPT 99214, an established patient office visit of moderate complexity rendered by Dr. Robert K. Lindqvist, MD (NPI 1314059687) at MUSC Health University Medical Center. MUSC Health respectfully contends that this denial is not supported by the clinical facts of the encounter and requests immediate reconsideration and payment at the allowed amount of \$293.04.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Mr. Pollich is a 58-year-old male with an active and complex medical history managed on an ongoing outpatient basis. His documented active conditions include hypertension (onset 1986), obesity, anemia, prediabetes, seizure disorder with history of single seizure (onset 2014, with prior EEG evaluation), hyperlipidemia, and chronic sinusitis. He carries active prescriptions for Hydrochlorothiazide 25 mg for long-standing hypertension and Simvastatin 10 mg for hyperlipidemia. The May 21, 2026 encounter was billed with a primary diagnosis of J06.9 (acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified) and a secondary diagnosis of G40.909, reflecting his established seizure disorder. Given the breadth of Mr. Pollich's active chronic conditions and current medication regimen, a moderate-complexity established patient evaluation and management visit is clinically consistent with the documented complexity of his care.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The denial categorizes CPT 99214 as a non-covered service under Mr. Pollich's Humana Open Access plan (Group GRP-55180, coverage period January 1, 2024 through December 31, 2026). MUSC Health disputes this characterization. CPT 99214 represents a standard outpatient evaluation and management service for an established patient — one of the most fundamental categories of covered benefits under any commercial or Medicare Advantage plan. Blanket exclusion of an established-patient office visit of moderate complexity would be inconsistent with both the requirements of Medicare Advantage coverage rules, which mandate that plans cover all services covered under traditional Medicare, and with generally accepted standards for commercial health plan benefit design.

The claim was submitted correctly with place of service code 22 (on-campus outpatient hospital), revenue code 0510, and appropriate ICD-10 diagnosis codes supported by the patient's documented medical history. The rendering provider, Dr. Lindqvist, is identified by a valid NPI. There is no indication in the denial that the claim was rejected for a coding or eligibility reason; rather, Humana has asserted a benefit exclusion without specifying which plan provision excludes a routine outpatient evaluation and management visit. MUSC Health requests that Humana identify the precise benefit exclusion language upon which it relies, as the denial as issued does not provide sufficient information to evaluate or rebut a specific contractual exclusion. In the absence of a clearly applicable exclusion, the claim should be processed and paid.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Humana conduct a full reconsideration of this claim, identify any specific benefit exclusion provision being applied, and, upon finding no valid exclusion, reprocess and pay Claim MUSC-72D8-1 at the contracted allowed amount of \$293.04. Should Humana uphold the denial, we request a written explanation citing the exact plan language and section under which CPT 99214 is excluded for this member. MUSC Health reserves all rights to pursue further levels of appeal, including external review, within the applicable timeframes.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

Senior Appeals Specialist, Revenue Cycle Management
MUSC Health — Revenue Cycle / Patient Financial Services
(843) 792-2300 | muschealth.org

Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record